IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 28

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

RESTRICTED STAFF COPY

RESTRICTED STAFF COPY. Contains answer keys and Listening transcripts. Do not distribute to candidates.

Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	44	forty-four
2	warm white	
3	Tasmanian oak	oak
4	charcoal	
5	acrylic	
6	23	twenty-third, 23rd
7	window mount	mount
8	conservation board	
9	order receipt	receipt
10	fitting fee	
11	A	
12	B	
13	C	
14	G	
15	D	
16	C	
17	F	
18	G	
19	H	

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	B	
21	C	
22	F	
23	A	
24	G	
25	D	
26	information	
27	first names	
28	agenda	
29	matters most	
30	separate sheet	
31	fuel	
32	metabolic rate	
33	ambient temperature	
34	energy savings	
35	muscle activity	
36	feeding	
37	night length	longer darkness, length
38	air temperature	temperature, colder environment
39	elevation	elevations
40	species-wide conclusions	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - Everyday social dialogue: ordering a custom frame for a print in Hobart

Toby Langford	Good morning, Harbour Edge Framing. Toby speaking. How can I help?
Eliza Wren	Hello. I would like a quote for framing this print. I measured it at home, but perhaps I used the wrong edges.
Toby Langford	We measure the paper itself. Your enquiry says forty-five centimetres wide, but the print is forty-four. Shall I record forty-four?
Eliza Wren	Yes, please. Forty-five included the temporary border, which will be removed. The height is thirty centimetres.

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Toby Langford	Now the mount. You ticked bright white, but beside this cream paper it looks cold. Warm white keeps the contrast gentle.
Eliza Wren	I agree. Please change the order to warm white. I considered pale grey as well, but it makes the sky in the print look dull.
Toby Langford	For the frame, we have pine, black aluminium and Tasmanian oak. The oak costs more, but its narrow profile suits the print.
Eliza Wren	Let us use Tasmanian oak. I expected to choose black aluminium, yet it feels too severe now that I can see it beside the picture.
Toby Langford	Would you like the timber left natural? We can also apply a charcoal finish or a light honey stain.
Eliza Wren	The honey stain is attractive, but the charcoal finish picks up the dark lines around the lighthouse. Charcoal is my final choice.
Toby Langford	Next is glazing. Ordinary glass is cheapest. Acrylic is lighter and safer in transport. Museum glass reduces reflections but raises the quote.
Eliza Wren	I carry pictures between my flat and my office, so low weight matters more than perfect reflection control. Use acrylic, not ordinary glass.
Toby Langford	The workshop needs nine days. Thursday the twenty-second of May would be possible late in the afternoon, but you said you work Thursdays.
Eliza Wren	Yes. Could I collect it on Friday the twenty-third instead? I can come before lunch.
Toby Langford	Good. The window mount will keep the print from touching the glazing. A decorative slip is not needed for separation.
Eliza Wren	Then no decorative slip. I would rather spend the money on suitable backing. What do you recommend?
Toby Langford	We use conservation board behind works on paper. Cardboard is cheaper, but it is not specified for this order.
Eliza Wren	Conservation board sounds sensible. I want the print protected, although it is not a valuable antique.
Toby Langford	Friday the twenty-third is available. Bring your order receipt; a photograph of it on your phone is acceptable. You will not need the card used for the deposit.
Eliza Wren	I will bring the order receipt. Is there anything I should know before I decide where to hang it?
Toby Langford	Avoid the wall above the radiator. Heat is unhelpful for paper. The interior wall near your bookcase sounded better than the sunny wall.
Eliza Wren	All right, not above the radiator and not beside the sunny window. Please include the hanging wire and hooks in the quote.
Toby Langford	The wire and two standard hooks are included. The total also includes the fitting fee, so there will not be a compulsory workshop charge added at collection.
Eliza Wren	Let me check the order: forty-four centimetres wide, warm white mount, Tasmanian oak with a charcoal finish, acrylic glazing, and collection on the twenty-third of May.

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Toby Langford	Correct. The window mount and conservation board provide the protective layers. Bring the receipt on Friday, and we will show you how the two hooks should be spaced.

Part 2 - Everyday social monologue: a neighbourhood flood-drill briefing in Winnipeg

Rowan Sinclair	Welcome to the Riverview flood drill. I am Rowan Sinclair, the coordinator. This is practice, so follow the marked route even if another street appears quicker.
Rowan Sinclair	We will begin with volunteer duties. The names appear on your page, and I will explain what each person does during the drill.
Rowan Sinclair	Maya Chen covers assigned homes. She checks whether residents received the alert and reports unanswered doors, but she does not enter.
Rowan Sinclair	Owen Patel meets residents who requested mobility help. He accompanies each person along the step-free route until check-in is complete.
Rowan Sinclair	Lina Brooks updates the noticeboard and sends practice messages. Household questions still go to Maya, not to Lina.
Rowan Sinclair	Marcus Lee moves empty sandbags and demonstrates filling. During the drill, nobody takes bags to private property.
Rowan Sinclair	Helen Ward stays at the marked first-aid post. Daniel Kim manages the pet enclosure instead of collecting animals.
Rowan Sinclair	Priya Shah stands at road closures and turns people from unsafe streets. She explains the detour but does not leave the barrier.
Rowan Sinclair	Remember: Maya checks homes, Owen assists with mobility, Lina sends updates, and Priya controls closures. The others handle bags, first aid and pets.
Rowan Sinclair	Now look at the neighbourhood map. North is at the top, where the Red River forms the boundary. Your starting point is the community centre in the south-west corner.
Rowan Sinclair	Two roads are closed on the plan. Do not use the Oak Street underpass beside the river, and do not cross the blocked eastern section of River Road.
Rowan Sinclair	From the community centre, the step-free route first goes east along Prairie Avenue. Before Willow Street, the municipal garage is on your left. The sandbag store is inside that garage.
Rowan Sinclair	Do not confuse it with the small building near the western underpass. That one holds road equipment, and the underpass beside it is closed.
Rowan Sinclair	Continue east and turn north on Willow Street. At the first crossroads you will see a small plaza. On its west side is the drinking-water station.
Rowan Sinclair	The booth opposite is for staff radios. It may look like a refreshment kiosk on the drawing, but residents should not queue there.
Rowan Sinclair	A little farther north, the library stands on the east side of Willow Street. The covered porch is our first-aid post. The main library doors remain locked during the exercise.
Rowan Sinclair	Across from the library is the outdoor rink. Its southern gate is the check-in shelter. Everyone must report there before moving to the final assembly point.
Rowan Sinclair	The northern rink gate is not open. Follow the arrows east from the check-in shelter, then go north on King Street. This avoids the closed part of River Road.

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Rowan Sinclair	The accessible assembly point is the raised school yard north-east of the rink. The nearby riverside lookout is lower, so it is not an assembly area.
Rowan Sinclair	Residents with pets should use the fenced service yard south-east of the library, beyond the radio booth. The animals stay there with the pet-support helper while owners check in.
Rowan Sinclair	Please do not leave an animal at the playground beside the school. That space remains open for families, but it has no secure gate or water bowls.
Rowan Sinclair	If you find that the route is too narrow for your mobility device, tell a buddy or route marshal. Do not attempt the underpass as an alternative.
Rowan Sinclair	At the school yard, staff will record arrival times only. They will not ask for medical details. The practice alert ends after every block captain has reported and the route team has checked both barriers.
Rowan Sinclair	To recap the map: supplies begin at the garage, water is at the plaza, first aid is on the library porch, and check-in happens at the rink before the school yard.
Rowan Sinclair	The pet yard is separate, south of the library. Keep to the arrows, respect both closures, and wait for the final message before returning home.

Part 3 - Educational discussion: two trainee mediators revise a housing-dispute role-play in Belfast

Orla Devlin	That role-play stalled earlier than I expected. Once the neighbours began arguing about the late-night music, we jumped straight to solutions.
Finn Hollis	Yes, and our opening was rushed. Let us rebuild the sequence before the next training session, starting with the purpose of each stage.
Orla Devlin	The worksheet calls the opening statement Stage R. Here we outline the process, confidentiality and our impartial role, rather than judging whose evidence is stronger.
Finn Hollis	Each person’s account is Stage T. We first hear events as that person understands them, saving our follow-up questions until the account has finished.
Orla Devlin	The issue summary is Stage K. It establishes the topics needing discussion. In our case, those include music, hallway use and messages through the landlord.
Finn Hollis	Interest exploration is Stage P. We look for practical needs behind stated demands, such as sleep, privacy, predictability or feeling respected.
Orla Devlin	Option generation is Stage M. The parties suggest possible approaches, while we postpone any judgment of those ideas until the next stage.
Finn Hollis	Evaluation and agreement come later. We confused those stages by rejecting suggestions as soon as they were spoken.
Orla Devlin	So the worksheet codes are clear: R introduces the process, T hears each account, K sets the topics, P uncovers needs, and M gathers ideas.
Finn Hollis	We also need to revise our wording. I told them to bring proof of every complaint, which made the session sound like a hearing.
Orla Devlin	Let us call photographs, notes and messages information rather than proof. They can help clarify events, but we are not deciding a legal case.
Finn Hollis	Agreed. I also proposed a ground rule saying they should use surnames. That felt formal and one participant kept forgetting it.

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Orla Devlin	They had already asked to use first names, so we should respect that preference. The useful rule is to speak to one another without insults.
Finn Hollis	What about the documents from the landlord? I thought we should verify them before adding anything to the agenda.
Orla Devlin	We can acknowledge them, but the dispute about noise belongs on the shared agenda whether or not a document settles the date of one incident.
Finn Hollis	Right. We are mapping what needs discussion, not ruling on admissibility. The hallway issue also goes on that list because both people raised it.
Orla Devlin	During interest exploration, I asked, Who is right about quiet hours? That invited another argument over positions.
Finn Hollis	A better question is, What matters most about the evenings at home? One neighbour may say sleep, while the other may mention having friends visit.
Orla Devlin	We can follow with questions about patterns and impact. We should avoid suggesting that either concern automatically outweighs the other.
Finn Hollis	For option generation, shall I write every suggestion on the whiteboard? It was difficult to keep the issue summary visible last time.
Orla Devlin	Use a separate sheet for options. Then the agreed agenda remains visible, and we can group similar ideas after the brainstorming stage.
Finn Hollis	Good. We should also tell participants that listing an option does not mean accepting it. Otherwise they may refuse to suggest anything flexible.
Orla Devlin	Exactly. Last time one neighbour proposed headphones, and the other heard that as a final demand. We need to mark it as an idea for later evaluation.
Finn Hollis	Another mistake was my summary. I said one neighbour wanted silence, but she had actually asked for predictable quiet after eleven.
Orla Devlin	That distinction is an underlying interest. Absolute silence is a position; reliable rest is the concern we can explore alongside the other person’s social needs.
Finn Hollis	Should we set a time limit for each uninterrupted account? Five minutes felt short, but ten allowed repeated accusations.
Orla Devlin	We can say about seven minutes and give a neutral reminder if someone repeats. The exact timing is a training choice, not a rule for every mediation.
Finn Hollis	At the end, any agreement must use the parties’ own decisions. We can test whether a proposal is clear and workable without drafting a solution for them.
Orla Devlin	And if they do not agree, we still close by summarising what was discussed and any points of progress. A session is not automatically a failure because no full settlement is reached.
Finn Hollis	Let me note our revisions: information, first names, noise on the shared agenda, a question about what matters most, and a separate sheet for options.
Orla Devlin	That should keep our role clear. We guide the sequence and communication, while the neighbours remain responsible for their choices.

Part 4 - Academic monologue: hummingbird torpor in a zoology lecture in Ottawa

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Lecturer	Today we will examine hummingbird torpor, a controlled reduction in physiological activity during the night.
Lecturer	Hummingbirds spend energy rapidly. Small bodies lose heat quickly, and hovering is expensive, so hours without feeding create an energy problem.
Lecturer	Before night, the amount of stored fuel matters. Researchers often discuss energy reserves when asking whether a bird enters torpor and how long it remains there.
Lecturer	This is not a switch determined by one measurement. Species, condition, feeding and weather may all influence the pattern.
Lecturer	During torpor, metabolic rate falls substantially. The bird uses energy more slowly than it would while maintaining its usual active temperature.
Lecturer	Body temperature also declines. In deeper torpor it may approach ambient temperature, although it remains physiologically regulated rather than becoming an uncontrolled response to cold.
Lecturer	The immediate benefit is energy savings. A bird can preserve fuel through a long night instead of spending continuously to keep its daytime temperature.
Lecturer	Depth and duration vary. Torpor is not identical in every individual or every night.
Lecturer	Entry is gradual. As evening activity ends, heat production declines and temperature follows. A lower overnight set point reduces the difference between the body and the surrounding air.
Lecturer	That smaller temperature difference reduces heat loss, which contributes to the saving. It does not mean the environment supplies the bird with energy.
Lecturer	Near dawn, the bird must rewarm. Muscle activity produces much of the necessary heat, and this process consumes part of the fuel conserved overnight.
Lecturer	Rewarming is therefore a cost, not free recovery. Its timing matters because a bird that becomes active early may reach flowers before competitors, but it also begins spending energy sooner.
Lecturer	Once active, feeding can restore reserves. Early access to nectar may be important, especially after a cold or lengthy night.
Lecturer	We can now separate the sequence: available reserves help shape entry, metabolic rate and body temperature fall, energy is conserved, muscle activity supports rewarming, and feeding follows renewed activity.
Lecturer	Let us turn to ecological variation. Night length can extend the period during which no food is available. Longer darkness can therefore increase the value of conserving energy.
Lecturer	Air temperature also changes the energetic challenge. A colder environment generally increases the cost of keeping a warm body above its surroundings.
Lecturer	Food conditions matter as well. A bird that accumulated ample reserves may use torpor differently from one that ended the day with less stored fuel.
Lecturer	Researchers test rather than assume these relationships. They measure body mass, record temperature, and identify each torpor bout.
Lecturer	One Andean study compared hummingbirds across elevations. Higher and lower sites differed in climate and ecological setting, allowing researchers to examine variation without claiming that elevation was the only cause.

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Lecturer	The study also considered species and individual differences. A pattern observed at one site may reflect the birds present there as well as the physical environment.
Lecturer	Another line of research asks whether a threshold of stored energy helps explain torpor use. The idea is useful because it produces predictions, but a simple threshold may not capture every bout.
Lecturer	Duration is especially informative. Two birds may both enter torpor, yet one remains in that state much longer. Counting entry alone would miss that distinction.
Lecturer	Researchers must also distinguish correlation from mechanism. If cold nights coincide with longer torpor, temperature is associated with the pattern, but food availability or night length may also contribute.
Lecturer	Controlled measurements clarify physiology, while field observations preserve ecological realism. Strong accounts combine both.
Lecturer	What does this mean for broad claims? First, do not describe torpor as an emergency response used only when a bird is nearly starving.
Lecturer	Some hummingbirds may use it strategically under conditions where conserving energy improves the overnight budget. That does not prove deliberate conscious planning.
Lecturer	Second, avoid species-wide conclusions from one population. Hummingbirds occupy diverse habitats, and closely related species can show different patterns.
Lecturer	Third, report what was actually measured. Skin temperature, body temperature, metabolic rate and movement are related indicators, but they are not interchangeable.
Lecturer	A temperature trace can identify cooling and rewarming, while oxygen consumption offers evidence about metabolism. Field equipment may make one measure easier than another.
Lecturer	Finally, remember the cost after torpor. Rewarming uses energy, and delayed activity may alter feeding opportunities. Energy saved overnight is only one side of the budget.
Lecturer	The central lesson is that torpor links physiology with ecology. Reserves and environmental conditions shape entry and duration; reduced metabolism and temperature save fuel; rewarming and renewed feeding complete the cycle.
Lecturer	When reading a study, ask which birds were measured, at what elevation, during which season, and with which physiological indicator. Those limits determine how far the conclusion can travel.
Lecturer	Torpor is remarkable, but the scientific explanation is strongest when it preserves variation instead of replacing it with a single dramatic rule.

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	support cable	cable
2	layer gap	gap
3	mesh junctions	junctions
4	larger drops	drops
5	collection gutter	gutter
6	storage pipe	pipe
7	airflow	
8	gravity	
9	direction	
10	turbulence	
11	dust	
12	spare mesh	
13	supplementary supply	
14	TRUE	
15	FALSE	
16	FALSE	
17	TRUE	
18	FALSE	
19	FALSE	
20	NOT GIVEN	
21	G	
22	A	
23	E	
24	B	
25	F	
26	D	
27	YES	
28	YES	

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	YES	
30	NO	
31	NO	
32	YES	
33	NOT GIVEN	
34	F	
35	C	
36	H	
37	A	
38	E	
39	I	
40	B	

© 2026 Idiomas WeLearn. Todos los derechos reservados. · idiomaswl.com
Uso personal y educativo. Prohibida su reproducción, venta o distribución sin autorización escrita.